



DANIEL & VERONICA'S

RELATIONSHIP ARCHITECTURE

— — — — — ♥ — — — — —
DESIGNED TO GROW. BUILT ON LOVE.

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LONG-TERM VISION	Lifelong Partnership

NAVIGATION

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SECTION 1

Executive Summary

This document defines the architecture of our relationship — its principles, values, systems, and governance. Like a software Architecture Design Document, it is the single source of truth for how we design, build, and maintain our life together.

Purpose

Why does this architecture exist? What problem does it solve for us?

OUR PURPOSE

Mission Statement

What we do, for each other, and why — one powerful sentence.

MISSION

Vision Statement

What are we building toward? The 10-year horizon in one sentence.

VISION

Success Definition

What does a thriving, healthy relationship look like specifically for us?

HOW WE DEFINE SUCCESS

Relationship Philosophy

Our core belief about love, partnership, and what it means to truly commit.

OUR PHILOSOPHY

SECTION 2

Guiding Principles

Our engineering principles — the non-negotiable rules that guide every decision, every conflict, and every season of our relationship. When in doubt, return to these.

♦ Love Before Ego	♦ Radical Honesty
♦ Team Over Individual	♦ Attack Problems, Not People
♦ Continuous Improvement	♦ Assume Positive Intent
♦ Protect Trust at All Costs	♦ Grace Over Perfection

ADDITIONAL PRINCIPLES

SECTION 3

Core Values (Foundation)

The values that define who we are as a couple. Every system, goal, and decision flows from these foundations.

Love & Respect

DEFINITION

BEHAVIORS

ANTI-PATTERNS

EXAMPLES

Communication

DEFINITION

EXPECTED BEHAVIORS

MEETING RULES

CONFLICT RULES

Trust

HOW TRUST IS BUILT

HOW TRUST IS REPAIRED

TRUST VIOLATIONS

Growth

Our commitment to continuous improvement across every domain of life.

LEARNING

HEALTH

SPIRITUAL

CAREER

FINANCIAL

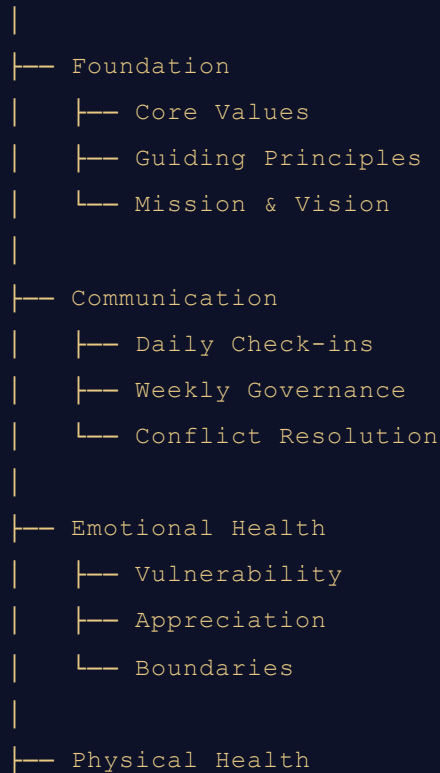
RELATIONSHIP

SECTION 4

System Architecture

Our relationship as a software system — the modules, interfaces, and dependencies that comprise the whole. Each component has its own requirements, inputs, outputs, and health metrics.

Relationship



- | | | — Fitness
- | | | — Nutrition
- | | | — Rest & Recovery
- |
- | — Finances
 - | | | — Budget
 - | | | — Savings
 - | | | — Investments & Goals
- |
- | — Home
 - | | | — Environment
 - | | | — Responsibilities
 - | | | — Hospitality
- |
- | — Family
 - | | | — Extended Family
 - | | | — Future Family Planning
 - | | | — Traditions
- |
- | — Adventure
 - | | | — Travel
 - | | | — Date Nights
 - | | | — New Experiences
- |
- | — Intimacy
 - | | | — Emotional Intimacy
 - | | | — Physical Intimacy
 - | | | — Quality Time
- |
- | — Conflict Resolution
 - | | | — Protocols
 - | | | — De-escalation
 - | | | — Repair
- |
- | — Future Planning
 - | | | — Short-Term Goals
 - | | | — Long-Term Goals
 - | | | — Life Milestones
- |

└─ Legacy
└─ Impact
└─ Heritage
└─ Purpose

SECTION 5

Weekly Governance Meeting

Our Sunday governance process. A standing meeting where we review our system, surface issues, make decisions, and align for the week ahead. Estimated duration: 60–90 minutes.

Check-in

Share briefly — no problem-solving yet. Just check in.

DANIEL

Mood

Energy Level

Stress Level

This Week's Win

Current Struggle

VERONICA

Mood

Energy Level

Stress Level

This Week's Win

Current Struggle

Appreciation

DANIEL → VERONICA

3 Things I'm Grateful For

3 Things You Did Well

VERONICA → DANIEL

3 Things I'm Grateful For

3 Things You Did Well

Open Issues

ANYTHING BOTHERING US, AVOIDED, OR UNRESOLVED?

Review Action Items

ACTION ITEM	OWNER	STATUS	NOTES

Metrics

Rate each area 1–10 for the week. Brief notes welcome.

AREA	DANIEL	VERONICA	NOTES
Overall Relationship			
Communication			
Connection & Intimacy			
Stress			
Finances			
Health			
Faith & Spiritual			
Fun & Adventure			

Decisions — Architectural Decision Records

Significant commitments we are making together. Document each one at the time of decision.

ADR-001 We will never go to bed angry without acknowledging the issue.		
DECISION We commit to always making contact — a word, a touch — before sleep, even mid-conflict.	REASON Silence overnight compounds distance. Acknowledgment preserves trust even when resolution waits.	CONSEQUENCES Either person may invoke this at any time. Resolution can continue in the morning.

ADR-____ *New decision title*

DECISION

REASON

CONSEQUENCES

New Goals

DAILY

WEEKLY

MONTHLY

YEARLY

LIFETIME

SECTION 6

Goals Architecture

Our goal system, structured like OKRs. Every goal flows from our vision and breaks down into executable tasks with clear ownership and deadlines.

GOAL

The big outcome we're working toward

MILESTONE

Key checkpoint that signals meaningful progress

TASKS

Specific actions to complete this week or month

OWNER

Daniel / Veronica / Both

DEADLINE

Specific target date

Active Goals

GOAL**MILESTONE****OWNER****DEADLINE****STATUS****SECTION 7**

Long-Term Roadmap

The architecture of our future — planned across every time horizon. Think of each phase as a software release cycle for our life together.

**1 YEAR**

Near-Term Horizon

KEY GOALS

WHERE WE WANT TO BE



5 YEARS

Mid-Term Vision

KEY GOALS

MAJOR MILESTONES



10 YEARS

Long-Term Architecture

LIFE WE'RE BUILDING

MAJOR MILESTONES



RETIREMENT

Freedom Phase

OUR RETIREMENT VISION

FINANCIAL TARGET



LEGACY



What We Leave Behind

HOW WE WANT TO BE REMEMBERED

IMPACT ON FAMILY, COMMUNITY, WORLD

SECTION 8

Risk Register

Known risks to our relationship and life system — documented with likelihood ratings, impact assessments, and mitigation plans. Like any good engineering team, we acknowledge risks proactively rather than ignoring them.

RISK	LIKELIHOOD	IMPACT	MITIGATION PLAN
Financial Stress	MEDIUM	HIGH	Monthly budget reviews; emergency fund; shared financial goals
Poor Communication	MEDIUM	HIGH	Weekly governance meetings; communication protocols; counseling if needed
Burnout	MEDIUM	MEDIUM	Regular stress check-ins; protected rest time; annual retreats
Family Conflict	LOW	MEDIUM	United-front policy; clear boundaries; family meetings when needed
Health Issues	LOW	HIGH	Proactive health maintenance; insurance coverage; emergency plan on file
Career Instability	MEDIUM	MEDIUM	Skills investment; 6-month emergency fund; active network building
Emotional Distance	LOW	HIGH	Intentional connection rituals; weekly check-ins; date nights protected

SECTION 9

Decision Log

Every significant life decision we make together — documented with reasoning and outcomes. This becomes our institutional memory as a couple.

Examples: buying a home, marriage, children, career moves, relocating, starting a business, major financial decisions

DATE	DECISION	REASONING	OUTCOME / NOTES

SECTION 10

Meeting Notes

A blank record page for each weekly governance session. Date each entry and reference relevant section numbers where useful.

MEETING DATE: _____ WEEK #: _____

Key Topics:

Notes:

Action Items:

MEETING DATE: _____ WEEK #: _____

Key Topics:

Notes:

Action Items:

MEETING DATE: WEEK #:

Key Topics:

Notes:

Action Items:

Appendix

Books & Resources

Books, podcasts, therapists, courses — anything that has shaped or continues to shape our thinking.

Dream Lists

DANIEL'S DREAMS

VERONICA'S DREAMS

Bucket List

Places to go, things to do, experiences to share as a couple.

Our Quotes

Words that define us — personal mantras, scripture, anything that speaks to who we are.

Anniversaries & Important Dates

DATE	EVENT	NOTES
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*"We're not just building a relationship.
We're architecting a life we love."*